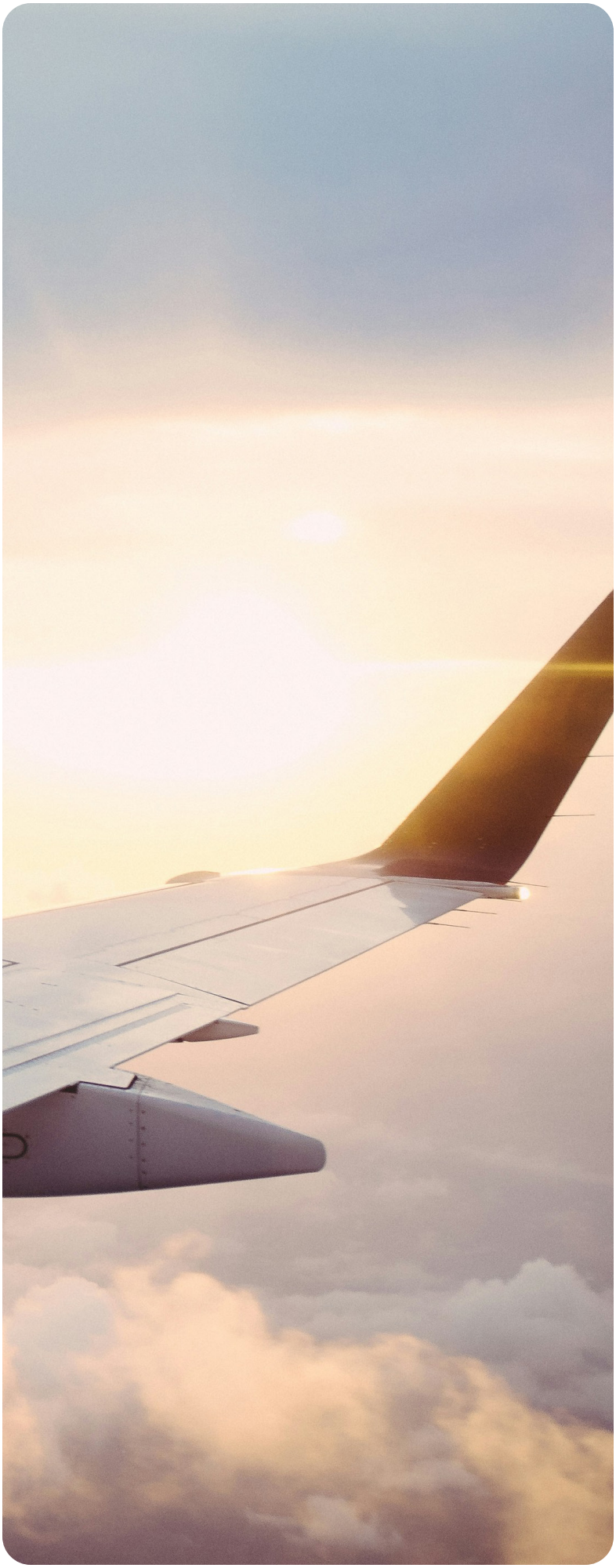


SANDS CAPITAL

International Growth

Quarterly Report
September 30, 2026
USD

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All investments are subject to market risk, including the possible loss of principal. Recent tariff announcements may add to this risk, creating additional economic uncertainty and potentially affecting the value of certain investments. Tariffs can impact various sectors differently, leading to changes in market dynamics and investment performance. International investments can be riskier than US investments due to the adverse effects of currency exchange rates, differences in market structure and liquidity, as well as specific country, regional and economic developments. In addition, the strategy is concentrated in a limited number of holdings. As a result, poor performance by a single large holding of the strategy would adversely affect its performance more than if the strategy were invested in a larger number of companies. The strategy's growth investing style may become out of favor, which may result in periods of underperformance.

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International Growth

International Growth seeks to own the best growth businesses outside of the United States. These businesses often feature durable, above-average earnings growth underpinned by secular change in both developed and emerging markets.

Investment Criteria

1. Sustainable above-average earnings growth
2. Leadership position in a promising business space
3. Significant competitive advantage/unique business franchise
4. Clear mission and value-added focus
5. Financial strength
6. Rational valuation relative to the market and business prospects

Key Attributes

September 30, 2026

Concentrated and Conviction-Weighted

Holdings	31 businesses
Top Ten Weight	53%

Long-Term Investment Horizon

Turnover (Annual Avg.)	19%
Expected Holding Period	5+ years

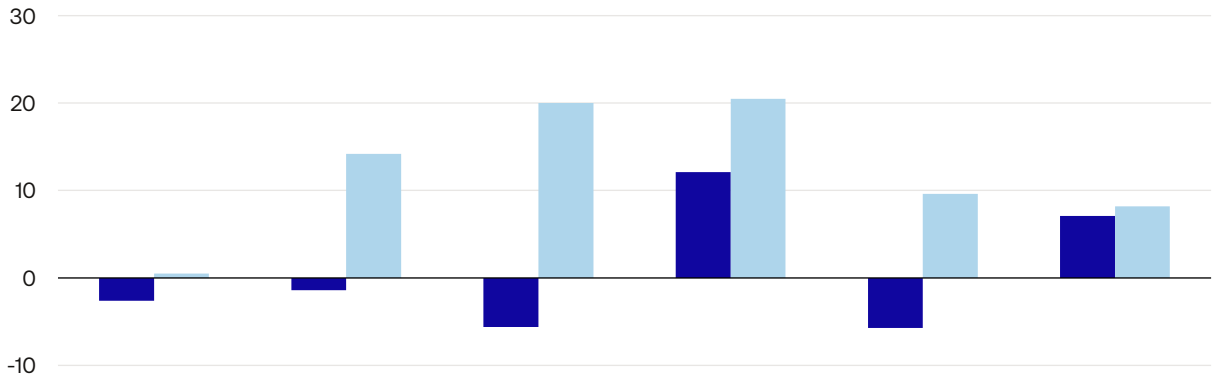
Growth-Oriented

Sands Capital Long-Term EPS Growth Estimate	31%

Investment Results (%)

International Growth vs. MSCI All Country World Index ex USA

As of 09/30/2026



	QTD	YTD	1 Year	3 Years	5 Years	Since Inception
Portfolio (Net)	-2.6	-1.4	-5.6	12.1	-5.7	7.1
Benchmark	0.5	14.2	20.0	20.5	9.6	8.2
Value Added (%)	-3.1	-15.7	-25.6	-8.4	-15.3	-1.1

Calendar Year Returns (%)

	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	YTD
Portfolio (Net)	-7.1	46.3	60.2	1.4	-41.0	16.0	8.4	10.9	-1.4
Benchmark	-13.2	21.5	10.7	7.8	-16.0	15.6	5.5	32.4	14.2
Value Added (%)	6.0	24.8	49.5	-6.5	-25.0	0.4	2.9	-21.5	-15.7

Inception date is 03/31/2018. Returns over one year are annualized. For strategies that commenced during a calendar year, the first annual return period shown will reflect less than 12 months of performance and is calculated from the strategy's inception date through December 31. In such cases, benchmark returns for the corresponding period are shown for the same partial-year timeframe. The investment results shown are net of advisory fees and expenses and reflect the reinvestment of dividends and any other earnings. The investment results are those of the International Growth Equity Composite. Net of fee performance was calculated by reducing International Growth Equity Composite's monthly gross return by 1/12 of the highest applicable annual fee of 0.85%. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Data Load ID: 670

Portfolio Characteristics

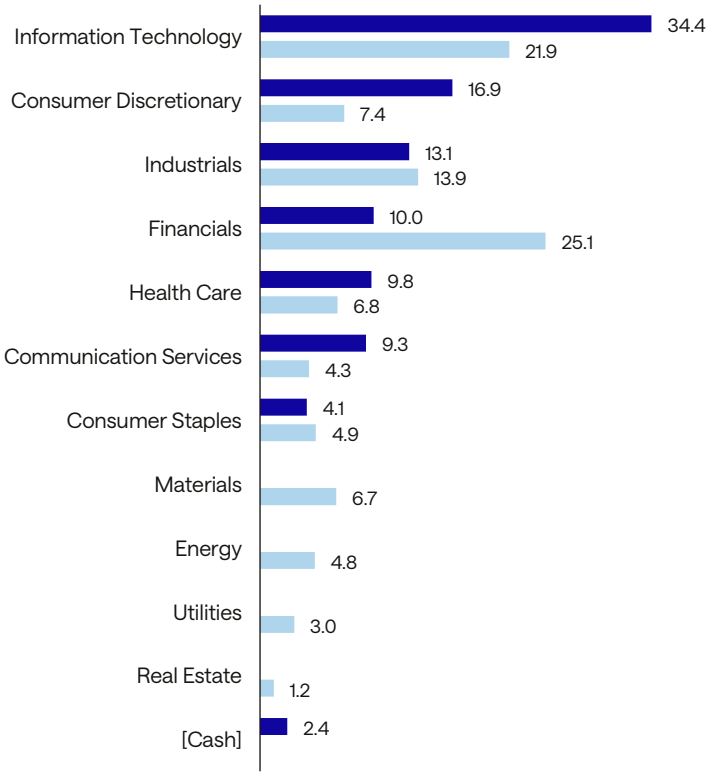
	Portfolio	Benchmark
Strategy Assets (USD)	$490M	n/a
Portfolio Businesses	31	1,901
Active Share	87%	n/a
5-Year Historical EPS Growth	22%	16%
Consensus Forward P/E - Next 12 mos.	20x	12x
Weighted Avg. Market Cap (USD)	$422.4B	$261.4B
Median Market Cap (USD)	$59.3B	$14.9B
Turnover - Trailing 12 mos.	15%	n/a

Efficiency and Volatility Metrics

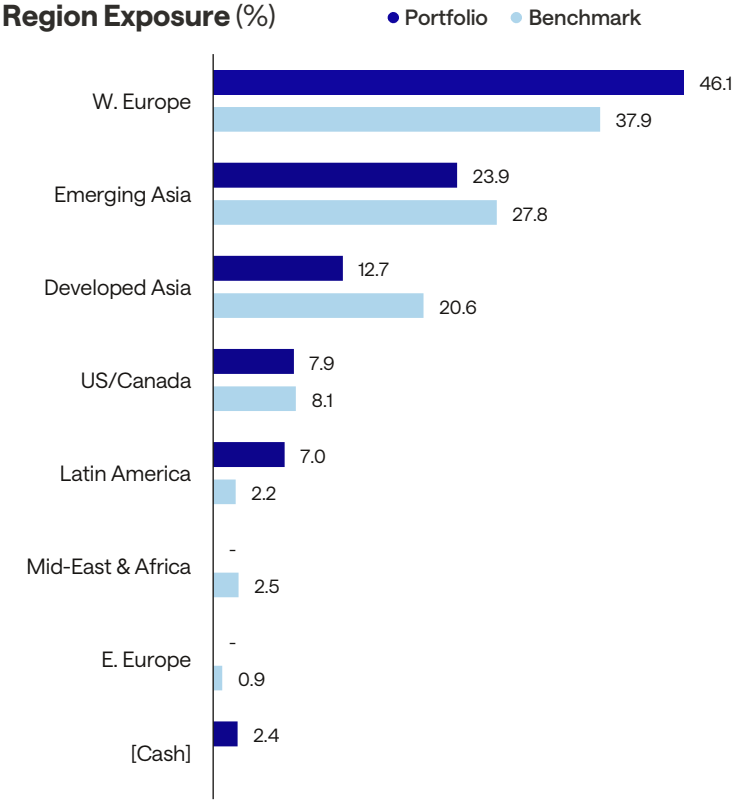
(Trailing 5 Years Net of Fees)	Portfolio	Benchmark
Beta	1.22	1
Information Ratio	-1.2	n/a
R-Squared	70.0%	100.0%
Sharpe Ratio	-0.4	0.4
Standard Deviation	22.4%	15.4%
Tracking Error	12.8%	n/a
Up Capture	82.3%	100%
Down Capture	146.4%	100%

Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Sector Exposure (%)



Region Exposure (%)



Top Ten Holdings (53.1% of Assets)

Company	Sector	Domicile	Weight (%)	Owned Since
Taiwan Semiconductor	Information Technology	Taiwan	11.1	2018
ASML Holding	Information Technology	Netherlands	6.9	2018
Shopify	Information Technology	Canada	6.0	2018
VAT Group	Industrials	Switzerland	4.7	2018
Galderma	Health Care	Switzerland	4.5	2025
Keyence	Information Technology	Japan	4.4	2018
Ajinomoto	Consumer Staples	Japan	4.1	2024
Addtech	Industrials	Sweden	4.1	2023
Spotify	Communication Services	Sweden	3.8	2024
MercadoLibre	Consumer Discretionary	Argentina	3.6	2018

Source: Benchmark data sourced from Benchmark providers. Company domicile, sector, industry, regional, and country classifications, where applicable, are sourced from MSCI. Other data sourced from FactSet.

Portfolio Holdings by Sector

Sector/Company	GICS Industry	Domicile	Portfolio (%)	Benchmark (%)	Owned Since
Communication Services			**9.3**	**4.3**	
CTS Eventim	Entertainment	Germany	2.8	0.0	2022
Formula One	Entertainment	United Kingdom	2.7	0.0	2022
Spotify	Entertainment	Sweden	3.8	0.2	2024
Consumer Discretionary			**16.9**	**7.4**	
Dollarama	Broadline Retail	Canada	1.9	0.1	2024
Ferrari	Automobiles	Italy	2.5	0.1	2023
Lenskart Solutions	Specialty Retail	India	2.0	0.0	2026
MercadoLibre	Broadline Retail	Argentina	3.6	0.0	2018
On Holding	Textiles, Apparel & Luxury Goods	Switzerland	1.5	0.0	2025
Sea	Broadline Retail	Singapore	3.3	0.1	2019
Titan	Textiles, Apparel & Luxury Goods	India	2.2	0.0	2024
Consumer Staples			**4.1**	**4.9**	
Ajinomoto	Food Products	Japan	4.1	0.1	2024
Financials			**10.0**	**25.1**	
3i Group	Capital Markets	United Kingdom	2.1	0.1	2025
Adyen	Financial Services	Netherlands	2.3	0.1	2019
Bajaj Finance	Consumer Finance	India	2.2	0.1	2018
HDFC Bank	Banks	India	1.7	0.2	2018
Nu Holdings	Banks	Brazil	1.7	0.1	2025
Health Care			**9.8**	**6.8**	
argenx	Biotechnology	Belgium	2.8	0.2	2025
EssilorLuxottica	Health Care Equipment & Supplies	France	1.6	0.1	2025
Galderma	Pharmaceuticals	Switzerland	4.5	0.1	2025
Pro Medicus	Health Care Technology	Australia	0.9	0.0	2025
Industrials			**13.1**	**13.9**	
Addtech	Trading Companies & Distributors	Sweden	4.1	0.0	2023
Siemens Energy	Electrical Equipment	Germany	2.6	0.3	2026
VAT Group	Machinery	Switzerland	4.7	0.1	2018
WEG	Electrical Equipment	Brazil	1.8	0.0	2022
Information Technology			**34.4**	**21.9**	
Arm Holdings	Semiconductors & Semiconductor Equipment	United Kingdom	1.3	0.0	2026
ASML Holding	Semiconductors & Semiconductor Equipment	Netherlands	6.9	1.9	2018
Keyence	Electronic Equipment Instruments & Components	Japan	4.4	0.3	2018
Samsung Electronics	Technology Hardware, Storage & Peripherals	Korea	1.4	2.8	2026
Shopify	IT Services	Canada	6.0	0.5	2018
SK hynix	Semiconductors & Semiconductor Equipment	Korea	3.3	2.0	2026
Taiwan Semiconductor	Semiconductors & Semiconductor Equipment	Taiwan	11.1	5.2	2018
Cash			2.4		

Data presented is that of the International Growth Equity Composite. The index represented will differ in characteristics, holdings, and sector weightings from that of the composite. The index does not contain cash and does not reflect the reinvestment of dividends. Rounding may cause totals to vary from 100.0%. GIPS Reports found here. Source: Sands Capital, FactSet, MSCI

Third Quarter 2026 Commentary

Market Environment

International equity markets were mixed during the third quarter as higher energy prices, rising sovereign bond yields, and tighter monetary policy offset resilient economic activity and corporate earnings. Brent crude rose toward $100 per barrel after the U.S.-Iran ceasefire broke down, contributing to renewed inflation concerns. Bond yields increased across Europe and Asia, with German, U.K., Japanese, and Australian benchmark yields reaching multiyear or multidecade highs. Central banks responded with additional tightening, including rate increases from the European Central Bank, Bank of Japan, and Reserve Bank of Australia.

European equities were approximately flat for the quarter after reaching record highs earlier in the period. Energy and banks outperformed, benefiting from higher oil prices and interest rates, while real estate and consumer-oriented businesses lagged. Corporate earnings remained resilient, and eurozone economic data generally exceeded expectations, although fiscal concerns in France and the U.K. contributed to market volatility.

Asian equity results varied considerably. Japan's TOPIX advanced as investors favored a broader range of financial, industrial, and domestically oriented businesses, while the technology-heavy Nikkei 225 declined. Hong Kong equities rose led by health care, banks, and energy businesses. By contrast, South Korean equities declined sharply amid weakness in memory semiconductor businesses, while Indian equities fell as higher oil prices pressured the inflation and interest-rate outlook. Singapore was among the strongest developed Asian markets, supported by its large banking sector.

Investment Results and Attribution

International Growth underperformed the MSCI ACWI ex-U.S. in 2026's third quarter. Security selection in consumer discretionary contributed to relative results, particularly among select Indian consumer brands. The portfolio's underweight to traditional value sectors such as financials, energy, and materials detracted, as they outperformed the broader index.

Overall, the U.S. and Canada was the top-contributing region to International Growth's relative results, while Developed Asia was the top detractor. From a sector perspective, consumer discretionary and utilities were the top relative contributors, while financials and health care were the top detractors.

The top absolute individual contributors were Shopify, Lenskart Solutions, Stevanato, Spotify, and Keyence.

Shopify is the leading global ecommerce platform enabling the next generation of retail. Shares advanced following strong second-quarter results and growing evidence that the company is well positioned to benefit from advancements in consumer AI agents. Revenue and gross merchandise volume both grew more than 30 percent year over year despite difficult comparisons, while margins continued to improve. Importantly, AI-driven traffic and orders to Shopify stores tripled, with AI-assisted shopping generating higher conversion and helping consumers discover products from smaller merchants across Shopify's long tail. On the merchant side, adoption of Shopify's AI tools also continued to expand, helping businesses operate and analyze their stores more efficiently. We maintain conviction that Shopify's scale, merchant ecosystem, and expanding AI capabilities can reinforce its competitive position and support continued profitable growth.

Lenskart Solutions is India's largest eyewear retailer by volume and value market share. First-quarter fiscal 2027 results confirmed our previously non-consensus constructive view on Lenskart's international business, which delivered 20 percent same-store sales growth year over year at an 11 percent EBITDA margin. While the core India business fell short of our optimistic volume projections, better-than-expected gross margins offset the miss, and the launch of $5 prescription eyeglasses should improve conversion rates following free eye examinations. Lenskart ended the quarter with 2,725 stores in India, and management sees opportunity for 10,000 more over the next several years. To execute on this opportunity, Lenskart is building capabilities to deliver a strong customer experience at scale. This includes offering $5 prescription lenses to capture first-time customers, building supply chain capabilities to reach new towns, and deploying self-tests and remote optometry to address the shortage of trained optometrists.

Stevanato supplies drug containers, delivery devices, and manufacturing equipment to pharmaceutical companies. Shares contributed while the company was held, but we exited the position during the quarter. Second-quarter revenue grew 8 percent year over year, and higher-value solutions increased 16 percent, supported by demand for products used with complex injectable medicines. The richer product mix improved margins. Free cash flow remained negative, however, as Stevanato continued investing in

new facilities and delivery-device programs. Management also reduced the upper end of its revenue guidance, partly reflecting a divestiture. We still see a sizeable opportunity in biologic medicines and injectable therapies. Our concern was the time and spending required to turn that opportunity into sustained cash generation, against a record of uneven execution following the pandemic.

Spotify offers music, podcasts, and audiobooks through subscriptions and advertising. Shares contributed as the company delivered further subscriber growth and higher profitability. Premium subscribers reached 300 million in the second quarter, while revenue increased 14 percent year over year and operating income rose 61 percent. Spotify reached 777 million monthly active users, extending its global scale. While user additions came in slightly below management's guidance, our research team remains focused on paid-subscriber growth, pricing, and the opportunity to convert more listeners to premium plans. We see meaningful potential for Spotify to increase revenue per user as it improves the service and expands its audio offerings, including products that use AI. These investments could deepen engagement and create new ways for listeners and creators to use the platform. We believe Spotify can build on its recent margin gains while continuing to grow paid subscriptions and develop new sources of revenue.

Keyence is a Japanese supplier of sensors, machine-vision systems, and measurement equipment that help manufacturers automate production and improve quality. Shares contributed to performance following fiscal first-quarter results that exceeded expectations. Revenue grew 23 percent excluding currency effects, while operating profit increased 45 percent and the operating margin reached 54 percent. Growth was broad across regions, with particularly strong demand in Asia from semiconductor, data center, and robotics customers. Investment in AI infrastructure is also supporting adjacent industries, including precision tools, electronics, and heating and cooling equipment, expanding the opportunity beyond chipmakers themselves. A domestic price increase and an improving product mix provided additional support. We continue to own Keyence for its differentiated products, pricing power, and ability to help customers improve productivity. We believe capacity expansion across the AI supply chain, alongside a recovering automotive investment outlook, can support continued demand for its automation solutions and durable earnings growth.

The top absolute individual detractors were SK hynix, ASML, Galderma, Taiwan Semiconductor, and Ajinomoto.

SK hynix is the world's market-share leader in high-bandwidth memory production. Shares fell sharply in July amid a reversal in high-momentum names before partially recovering in August and September. Second-quarter results also pressured shares, as revenue and earnings were modestly below consensus. We view the miss as less concerning, as it largely reflected mix and timing. A portion of high-bandwidth memory shipments shifted from the second into the third quarter, while a heavier mobile memory mix diluted average selling prices. In our view, SK hynix's multiyear supply agreements are more consequential than the quarter itself. We believe they can sustain elevated margins for longer, dampen the industry's boom-bust cycle, and enable share repurchases that we do not believe sell-side estimates yet reflect. Management also announced a shareholder return plan, targeting more than 50 percent of cumulative free cash flow from 2025 to 2027 for dividends, repurchases, and cancellations. Consensus estimates for 2027 and 2028 earnings rose 4 percent and 12 percent, respectively. Shares ended the quarter at 4 times forward earnings, close to all-time lows.

ASML traded lower in July alongside semiconductor-related businesses more broadly. Later in the quarter, news of an emerging Chinese state-backed lithography maker sparked a decline, and the threat of additional export restrictions on equipment sales to China also weighed on investor sentiment. We looked past the stock's fluctuation this quarter and continue to own the business at a large absolute and relative weight. The business maintains its chokepoint position in the leading-edge chip fabrication value chain, with most of 2027's production already reserved and bookings extending into 2028. This suggests to us that ASML's planned capacity ramp is backed by real customer demand rather than speculative orders. During the quarter, ASML also announced commitments from chipmakers to use 12-inch photomasks for advanced-node production into the early 2030s, in collaboration with Taiwan Semiconductor. We view this as a further positive indicator of demand durability and technological leadership. While competition from China is worth monitoring, we estimate that its production and technological capabilities remain meaningfully behind ASML's and are likely to largely address domestic demand only. Meanwhile, China now accounts for the smallest percentage of ASML's overall sales since 2022.

Galderma is a Switzerland-based dermatology company spanning injectable aesthetics, skin care, and prescription therapies. Shares detracted from performance as investors weighed a delay in U.S. approval of Relfydess, its next-generation wrinkle treatment, despite strong results across the business. The FDA raised questions about

manufacturing and analytical methods; it did not identify deficiencies in the product's safety or efficacy. Meanwhile, second-quarter sales grew 25 percent year over year at constant currency, led by Nemluvio, Galderma's treatment for inflammatory skin conditions. Nemluvio generated $248 million in quarterly sales, while neuromodulators and dermatological skin care also grew at double-digit rates. Galderma raised its full-year sales growth outlook to a range of 19 percent to 21 percent, reflecting this broad momentum. We continue to own the business and view the approval delay as a near-term setback to its U.S. expansion rather than a change to our broader investment thesis. Continued Nemluvio adoption, market-share gains in aesthetics, and growth in skin care support our outlook as Galderma works with the FDA on Relfydess.

Taiwan Semiconductor (TSMC) shares fluctuated alongside semiconductor stocks more broadly, with a large July decline and a choppy recovery afterward. The AI ecosystem faced several debates over the course of the quarter, one of which was the emergence of open models as a credible alternative to closed models for many use cases. For TSMC, what matters most for our AI investment case is ongoing scaling progress and token growth driven by training leading-edge models. In our view, whether this is done by frontier labs or not should not matter for fabrication demand. The durability of the AI investment cycle more broadly also continues to drive sentiment for TSMC, but September's announced 10 percent price hike reflects continued ecosystem demand and the business's persistent pricing power. We continue to own the business at a large weight across portfolios. A deceleration in overall industry billings is one gauge we are monitoring and could be a headwind to TSMC's near-term investment results. That said, consensus estimates for TSMC's 2027 and 2028 earnings rose over the course of the quarter, so this is not yet a warning sign.

Ajinomoto sells food, seasonings, specialty ingredients, biotechnology products, and functional materials used in advanced semiconductor packaging, all built on a common foundation in amino science. Shares declined despite fiscal first-quarter results that we viewed as strong, following share price appreciation earlier in the year. Group sales rose 13 percent year over year and business profit rose 27 percent, both ahead of consensus expectations. Functional Materials drove most of the upside, with sales up 54 percent and business profit up 77 percent as demand strengthened for higher-value Ajinomoto Build-up Film, an insulation material used in the packaging of most graphics processing units. Management raised its full-year forecast, and the revision came from Functional Materials. Food remained a steady source of earnings, while the smaller frozen foods business was weaker. In our view, the shares have continued to track sentiment toward AI and semiconductor demand more closely than the company's reported results. We continue to view semiconductor materials as Ajinomoto's principal earnings driver, and our research indicates that demand could exceed the cautious assumptions embedded in management's full-year forecast. We are monitoring whether order strength continues through the year and whether a richer product mix sustains the segment's recent profitability.

Portfolio Activity

International Growth exited **Stevanato** during the third quarter. We redeployed the proceeds toward Siemens Energy, an existing portfolio company which we believe offers clearer visibility into future growth and cash flow.

Outlook

We continue to invest in a market that seems increasingly short-term and skittish, one that often moves for reasons that have little to do with what a business is worth. Passive vehicles allocate by index weight rather than judgment, thematic funds concentrate capital around a single story, and leverage accelerates the swings in both directions. As more money trades on flows, factors, and narratives, prices detach from underlying value more frequently and more violently.

We believe this environment, uncomfortable as it feels in the moment, favors investors willing to do the opposite. The index has done well, but it is built by looking backward: rebalancing mechanically and with a lag, adding leadership after it is established, and shedding it after it has broken.

The AI trade itself has grown more complicated, shaped by technological, corporate, and geopolitical developments in combination rather than any one of them alone. Investors continue to debate whether current capital spending is sustainable and how quickly it will translate into returns. This is where we believe discretion matters most, in what we choose to own today and how quickly we can act for tomorrow. We are already seeing signs of AI monetization within our own portfolio, and in many cases these signs are emerging in businesses that are diluted within the index or excluded from it altogether. In a period this volatile and uncertain, we believe the case for weighing businesses individually, rather than owning the market by default, grows stronger rather than weaker.

Related Perspectives



Korea in Demand

Korea's opportunity set has broadened as global demand rises for trusted suppliers across AI infrastructure, semiconductors, power equipment, shipbuilding, nuclear, robotics, and beauty.

Article | Emerging Markets | On the Road | 12 min read



Beyond GPUs: The Broadening of AI Infrastructure

As AI systems evolve from passive prediction engines into autonomous agents capable of reasoning, planning, and executing complex tasks, the nature of infrastructure demand is beginning to change.

Article | Artificial Intelligence | Secular Trends | 5 min read

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This material may contain forward-looking statements, which are subject to uncertainty and contingencies outside of Sands Capital's control. Readers should not place undue reliance upon these forward-looking statements. There is no guarantee that Sands Capital will meet its stated goals. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

AI can create "winners" and "losers" in markets. "Winners" are those who can leverage AI to enhance productivity and efficiency. "Losers" may include companies whose products and services are at risk of replacement. Investments in companies utilizing artificial intelligence (AI) involve additional risks. AI technologies are rapidly evolving and may be subject to regulatory uncertainty, ethical concerns, and operational challenges. There is no assurance that AI-driven strategies will be successful, and companies may face risks related to data quality, model accuracy, cybersecurity, and unintended outcomes, which could adversely affect business results and investment performance. Companies that manufacture AI infrastructure are subject to risks including rapid technological change, competitive pressures, supply chain disruptions, regulatory developments, customer concentration, and fluctuations in demand for AI-related products and services, which may adversely affect financial performance and valuations.

Differences in account size, timing of transactions and market conditions prevailing at the time of investment may lead to different results, and clients may lose money. A company's fundamentals or earnings growth is no guarantee that its share price will increase. Forward earnings and revenue projections are not predictors of stock price or investment performance, and do not represent past performance. Characteristics, sector exposure and holdings information are subject to change, and should not be considered as recommendations. The specific securities identified and described do not represent all of the securities purchased, sold, or recommended for advisory clients. There is no assurance that any securities discussed will remain in the portfolio or that securities sold have not been repurchased. You should not assume that any investment is or will be profitable. Upon request, a complete list of securities purchased and sold will be provided. A full list of public portfolio holdings, including their purchase dates, is available here. To receive a complete list of and description of the calculation methodology for the attribution analysis and complete list detailing each holding's attribution please contact a member of the Client Relations Team at 703-562-4000.

Contribution Analysis (Net %)

Quarter to Date

Top Absolute Contributors

Company Name	Avg. Weight	Return	Contribution
Shopify	5.4	29.6	1.3
Lenskart Solutions	1.8	31.1	0.4
Stevanato Group	1.3	24.4	0.3
Spotify	3.9	5.9	0.2
Keyence	4.2	2.8	0.2

Bottom Absolute Detractors

Company Name	Avg. Weight	Return	Contribution
SK hynix	3.2	-22.5	-1.0
ASML Holding	6.6	-9.1	-0.7
Galderma	4.7	-13.2	-0.6
Taiwan Semiconductor	10.2	-4.6	-0.5
Ajinomoto	4.2	-9.8	-0.5

Trailing 1 Year

Top Absolute Contributors

Company Name	Avg. Weight	Return	Contribution
Taiwan Semiconductor	9.4	63.6	4.7
ASML Holding	5.5	87.1	3.3
VAT Group	3.8	107.7	2.5
Keyence	3.7	37.1	1.2
SK hynix	1.6	79.9	1.1

Bottom Absolute Detractors

Company Name	Avg. Weight	Return	Contribution
Sea	3.9	-46.6	-2.8
Flutter Entertainment	1.6	-59.3	-2.1
EssilorLuxottica	2.0	-53.9	-2.0
CTS Eventim	3.6	-38.2	-2.0
Spotify	4.2	-31.3	-1.7

Trailing 3 Year

Top Absolute Contributors

Company Name	Avg. Weight	Return	Contribution
Taiwan Semiconductor	6.2	437.5	10.6
ASML Holding	4.8	210.3	6.5
Shopify	4.5	167.7	4.5
MercadoLibre	5.2	32.2	3.6
Adyen	3.8	29.2	3.3

Bottom Absolute Detractors

Company Name	Avg. Weight	Return	Contribution
EssilorLuxottica	0.7	-54.1	-2.0
Flutter Entertainment	2.2	-51.6	-1.5
Genmab	0.8	-38.8	-1.3
On Holding	0.9	-51.7	-1.3
SMC	0.8	-44.6	-1.3

Trailing 5 Year

Top Absolute Contributors

Company Name	Avg. Weight	Return	Contribution
Taiwan Semiconductor	5.6	331.2	8.4
ASML Holding	5.3	149.3	5.9
VAT Group	3.1	119.7	3.4
MercadoLibre	4.7	-0.9	3.2
Addtech	2.4	57.9	2.3

Bottom Absolute Detractors

Company Name	Avg. Weight	Return	Contribution
Nihon M&A Center	1.0	-85.8	-4.7
Atlassian	1.8	-50.1	-4.2
M3	1.0	-82.3	-4.0
Sea	3.5	-73.3	-3.5
Zalando	1.6	-65.3	-2.9

All values are those of the International Growth Equity Composite. The companies identified above represent a subset of current and former holdings in the International Growth portfolio and were selected based on the performance measures presented. With the exception of IPOs where actual transacted prices are used, contributions are calculated in FactSet Portfolio Analysis using FactSet end of day prices, and do not reflect actual purchase prices. This can affect the presentation of contribution and performance of transactions amid heightened volatility. Security return and contribution are net of advisory fees and expenses and reflect the reinvestment of dividends and any other earnings. Attribution generated returns will not match actual performance because FactSet uses different exchange rate sources, the performance does not capture intra-day trading, and the analysis removes the impact of cash flows. Relative Return calculations do not incorporate risk or volatility impacts and should not be exclusively relied upon. To receive a description of the calculation methodology for the attribution analysis and a complete list detailing each holding's attribution please contact a member of the Client Relations Team at 703-562-4000. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Stewardship

Carbon Exposure

International Growth vs. MSCI All Country World ex USA Index
Reported September 30, 2026

Carbon Footprint

	Carbon Emissions	Carbon Intensity	Weighted Average Carbon Intensity	Carbon Emissions Data Availability
International Growth	4.4	28.2	35.5	97%
MSCI All Country World Index ex USA	86.4	163.4	148.7	100%
	tCO_2e/$M Invested	tCO_2e/$M Sales		Market Value

Carbon Emissions are calculated as Scope 1 & Scope 2 carbon emissions per $1 million invested. Portfolio and Benchmark Carbon Intensity is defined as the portfolio or benchmark carbon emissions per $1 million of portfolio or benchmark sales. At a business level, carbon intensity is calculated as carbon emissions per unit of sales (tons/$ 1 million sales). Weighted averages are computed as the sum product of the portfolio or benchmark companies' respective carbon values and portfolio or benchmark companies' weights.

Largest Contributors to Portfolio Weighted Average Carbon Intensity

Company	Portfolio Weight (%)	Carbon Intensity (S1+2) tCO_2e/$m	Contribution to Weighted Average Carbon Intensity
Taiwan Semiconductor	11.4	174.9	20.5
Ajinomoto	4.2	112.6	4.9
SK hynix	3.4	115.9	4.1
Samsung Electronics	1.5	85.0	1.3
Sea	3.4	29.9	1.0

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Proxy Voting

Proxy voting is an important part of our commitment to being an active, long-term owner and to fulfilling our fiduciary duty to act in the best interests of our clients.

Who Makes the Decision?

Voting decisions are made by members of our investment research team, those who know the business, and are typically directed by the lead analyst on the business.

What Information Do We Consider?

Our evaluation of each meeting agenda typically considers company proxy documents, our own research on the business, recent discussions with management, and third-party analysis.

While we do consider independent proxy advisers' guidance, we do not delegate our voting or rely upon such guidance in our voting decisions.

How Do We Approach Management Proposals?

Because management quality is a key criterion in identifying businesses for our portfolios, we tend to vote proxy proposals in favor of management. When we intend to vote against management, we may discuss the rationale for our decision with management.

International Growth Voting Activity
TTM Ending September 30, 2026

Votes	Businesses	Resolutions	%
Cast in Favor of Management	28	445	92%
Cast Against Management	12	28	6%
Abstentions	2	12	2%
		485	100%

Engagement enables us to better understand management's long-term vision and discuss how they manage ESG risks and opportunities, among other issues.

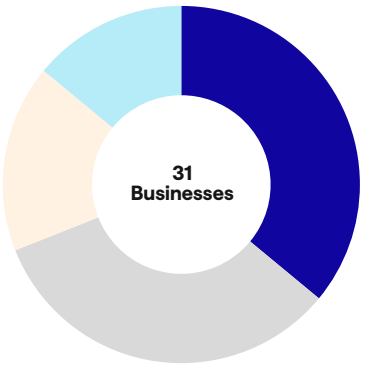
We meet regularly with the management teams of our portfolio businesses. Typically, they recognize us for our long-term investment orientation and focus on value creation.

We proactively express our views regarding business strategy, governance, financial reporting, executive compensation, and other stakeholder considerations when merited.

We are not activists and do not invest with the intention of pressuring management teams or pursuing campaigns to materially change our portfolio businesses.

We are objective and business-focused. We reserve the option to sell our shares if management is unable to address our concerns, which could reduce our conviction in the company's fit with our investment criteria.

International Growth Engagement Activity
TTM Ending September 30, 2026



- Business Strategy: 36%
- Governance: 33%
- Social: 17%
- Environment: 14%

ESG Topics Generally Addressed

Governance

Board structure or composition
Increasing transparency and disclosure
Executive compensation
Management accountability
Capital structure
Regulation
ESG strategy and oversight
Shareholder protection and rights
Related-party transactions

Social

Human capital management
Regulation
Product safety and impact
Health and safety
Human rights
Data security and privacy
Diversity and inclusion
Labor rights
Digital ethics

Environment

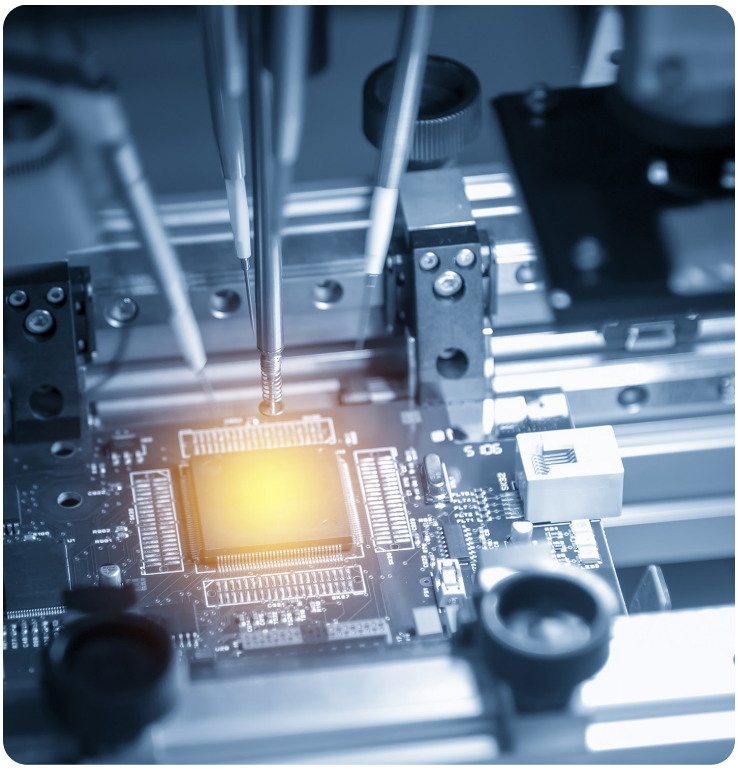
Materials use and sourcing
Energy use and efficiency
GHG emissions or climate change strategy
Regulation
Environmental policy and strategy
Pollution and waste management
Water use and efficiency

We may refrain from voting when issues arise that cause us to determine that voting proxies is not in the best interest of our clients or that it is not reasonably possible to determine whether voting proxies will be in the best interests of clients. Additionally, we do not vote in certain countries that require "share blocking," due to the possible liquidity constraints that could result in the cost of voting outweighing the benefit to the client. Shares out on loan also may not be voted. Sands Capital is not an activist investor and generally does not acquire or hold investments for the purpose or effect of changing or influencing the control of its investee companies.

As part of our ongoing research, Sands Capital regularly engages with the management teams and, if appropriate, board members of portfolio businesses to better understand each business's long-term strategic vision and management of risks and opportunities, including those pertaining to environmental, social, and governance (ESG) matters. The use of the term "active ownership" and Sands Capital's engagement with management teams and board members do not involve any direct or indirect attempt to exert pressure to implement specific measures, change policies, or otherwise influence control over the issuer.

Select Engagement Report

ASML Holding



Business:
ASML is a global market-leading supplier of lithography equipment, which uses concentrated light to imprint circuit patterns onto silicon wafers.

Key issues:
Environmental policy and strategy, energy use and efficiency, and regulation.

Background

ASML operates within a complex global semiconductor ecosystem, where commercial priorities increasingly intersect with national-security concerns and government policy. Our engagement explored how the company is adapting to these pressures, protecting the resilience of its supplier network, and pursuing its climate commitments as the semiconductor industry expands.

Adapting to geopolitical complexity

We asked how ASML balances competing stakeholder expectations and whether heightened geopolitical scrutiny has required changes to its governance or decision-making processes. The company described significant investments in its compliance capabilities in response to increasingly complex regulations and a sharp rise in related requests. These changes have required additional resources to interpret and respond to evolving requirements.

ASML also expanded its government relations team across multiple geographies. Company representatives emphasized the importance of helping policymakers understand the semiconductor industry, including the technologies, applications, and commercial relationships affected by export controls. They described sustained dialogue and education as central to navigating an increasingly political environment.

The discussion provided greater visibility into how ASML has strengthened its capacity to manage regulatory demands. ASML's response focused primarily on expanding compliance and government relations resources, providing less detail on how competing stakeholder interests are resolved within formal governance processes.

Understanding ecosystem vulnerabilities

We also asked which factors present the greatest long-term risks to ASML's broader ecosystem, including suppliers, talent, and research partnerships. The company identified its supply chain as the most immediate area of attention and geopolitical uncertainty as a significant ongoing challenge.

ASML described talent availability as a less pressing concern. The company indicated that its attractiveness as an employer in Europe continues to support recruitment and that it was not experiencing significant difficulties attracting people. This helped focus the discussion on supplier resilience and geopolitical pressures as the business' more prominent concerns at the time of the engagement.

Delivering on climate commitments

Our climate discussion examined how ASML is pursuing its sustainability ambitions alongside rapid industry growth. The company reported progress in addressing Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions, which cover its direct operations and purchased energy. It also described constructive collaboration with customers on reducing energy consumption, supported by growing customer interest in energy efficiency.

Progress with suppliers has proved more challenging. ASML cited lower transparency and less scrutiny within its supply chain, making this an area where delivering on its climate ambitions has been more difficult. Company representatives noted that this contrasted with their initial expectation that customer engagement would present the greater challenge.

ASML reaffirmed that sustainability remains a strategic commitment. The company indicated that it had made a deliberate decision to prioritize environmental, social, and governance considerations early on and had no intention of changing that direction.

Engagement outcome

The engagement strengthened our understanding of ASML's response to geopolitical and regulatory complexity and highlighted supplier transparency as a challenge in executing its climate strategy. It also clarified that customer collaboration has been more productive than the company initially expected. These insights provide a basis for future discussions on supplier engagement, measurable climate progress, and the governance processes supporting difficult geopolitical decisions.

This report is an example of the type of fundamental research Sands Capital conducts and, as such, contains the opinions and comments of Sands Capital at points in time. Additional or subsequent information may cause Sands Capital's views to change. This report is not a complete analysis of all material facts and therefore is not a sufficient basis alone on which to base an investment decision. This material may include summaries and references to research notes, emails, conference calls, and meetings, and there is no guarantee or representation that this information is complete, current, or accurate. The information contained herein has been prepared from sources believed reliable but is not guaranteed by us as to its timeliness or accuracy and is not a complete summary or statement of all available data. This report is for informational purposes only. As part of our ongoing research, Sands Capital regularly engages with the management teams and, if appropriate, board members of portfolio businesses to better understand each business's long-term strategic vision and management of risks and opportunities, including those pertaining to environmental, social, and governance (ESG) matters. Sands Capital's engagement with management teams and board members does not involve any direct or indirect attempt to exert pressure to implement specific measures, change policies, or otherwise influence control over the issuer. The company illustrated represents a holding in the Sands Capital strategies as of September 30, 2026, and was selected by the author on an objective basis to illustrate the views expressed in the Commentary. The example was selected based on the recent date of the engagements and topics discussed. The assessment of each business is based on factors that we believe are material to the long-term investment case. To receive a complete list of company engagements for the prior twelve months please contact a member of the Client Relations Team at 703-562-4000.

International Growth Equity Composite (IGEC) GIPS Report

Year End	# Accounts	End of Period AUM (USD $M)	IGEC Returns (Net)	IGEC Returns (Gross)	IGEC Annualized 3Y Std. Dev. (Net)	MSCI ACWI ex USA MSCI ACWI ex USA	MSCI ACWI ex USA Annualized 3Y Std. Dev.	Non-Fee Paying % of Composite	Asset Wgt'd Std. Dev. (Gross)	Firm Total Assets (USD $M)
2025	<5	$137.55	10.89	11.83	18.47	32.39	11.56	0.69	n.m.[1]	$48,202.34
2024	<5	$127.58	8.45	9.36	24.95	5.53	16.02	1.37	n.m.[1]	$47,462.52
2023	<5	$74.96	15.98	16.95	25.26	15.62	16.07	2.14	n.m.[1]	$46,746.96
2022	<5	$53.23	-41.00	-40.46	26.68	-16.00	19.25	2.58	n.m.[1]	$40,707.08
2021	<5	$64.79	1.35	2.22	19.30	7.82	16.79	3.55	n.m.[1]	$75,340.29
2020	<5	$2.25	60.19	61.53	—[2]	10.65	—[2]	100.00	n.m.[1]	$68,621.83
2019	<5	$1.40	46.28	47.49	—[2]	21.51	—[2]	100.00	n.m.[1]	$44,636.85
2018[3]	<5	$0.95	-7.14	-6.54	—[2]	-13.17	—[2]	100.00	n.m.[1]	$35,387.67

Net Returns

As of 09/30/2026	QTD	YTD	1 Year	3 Years	5 Years	Since Inception (03/31/2018)
IGEC	-2.6	-1.4	-5.6	12.1	-5.7	7.1
MSCI ACWI ex USA	0.5	14.2	20.0	20.5	9.6	8.2

[1] n.m. - Not statistically meaningful, five or less accounts in the composite for the entire year. [2] The 3-year annualized standard deviation is not shown due to the composite having less than 36 months of returns. [3] Annual performance results reflect partial period performance. The returns are calculated from 03/31/18 to 12/31/18 for both the composite and the index. As of October 1, 2021, the firm was redefined to be the combination of Sands Capital Management, LLC and Sands Capital Alternatives, LLC (previously known as Sands Capital Ventures, LLC). Both firms are registered investment advisers with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission in accordance with the Investment Advisers Act of 1940, as amended. The two registered investment advisers are combined to be one firm for GIPS purposes and are doing business as Sands Capital. Sands Capital operates as a distinct business organization, retains discretion over the assets between the two registered investment advisers, and has autonomy over the total investment decision making process. Prior to October 1, 2021, the firm was defined as Sands Capital Management, LLC, is an independent registered investment adviser. Sands Capital claims compliance with the Global Investment Performance Standards (GIPS®) and has prepared and presented this report in compliance with the GIPS® standards. Sands Capital has been independently verified for the periods February 7, 1992 through December 31, 2025. A firm that claims compliance with the GIPS standards must establish policies and procedures for complying with all the applicable requirements of the GIPS standards. Verification provides assurance on whether the firm's policies and procedures related to composite and pooled fund maintenance, as well as the calculation, presentation, and distribution of performance, have been designed in compliance with the GIPS standards and have been implemented on a firm-wide basis. The International Growth Equity Composite ("IGEC") has had a performance examination for the periods March 31, 2018 through December 31, 2025. The verification and performance examination reports are available upon request. The IGEC reflects information from all fee paying and non-fee paying accounts managed in the International Growth Equity strategy. The International Growth strategy is a concentrated portfolio that normally consists of the equity securities of 25 to 40 primarily large and mid-capitalization growth businesses. Portfolio companies are domiciled, operated, listed, or derive a significant portion of their revenues, profits, or productive assets outside of the United States in both developed and emerging markets. The portfolio may invest in ADRs, foreign securities traded on foreign exchanges, and may include the use of derivative access products including Low Exercise Price Warrants ("LEPWs") and Participation Notes ("P-Notes") to gain exposure to certain foreign markets where direct investment is restricted or not always practical or cost efficient. The strategy may experience losses as it is subject to equity securities risk, market and issuer risk, selection risk, growth style risk, concentration risk, currency exchange risk, foreign company risk, derivatives risk and other economic risks that may influence the returns of this strategy. The benchmark for the IGEC is the MSCI ACWI ex USA, a free float-adjusted market capitalization weighted index that is designed to measure the equity market performance of developed (excluding the US) and emerging markets. The IGEC holds securities not included in the MSCI ACWI ex USA and Sands Capital may invest in securities not covered by the index. Results are based on fully discretionary accounts under management. The annual composite dispersion presented is an asset-weighted standard deviation calculated of performance dispersion for accounts in the composite for the entire year, using beginning of period values. The U.S. dollar is the currency used to express performance. Returns include the effect of foreign currency exchange rates. Gross and net performance includes the reinvestment of all income and is presented net of expenses, foreign withholding taxes on dividends, interest income, and capital gains. Withholding taxes may vary according to the investor's domicile. The benchmark return is net of the maximum withholding tax rate of the constituent company's country of incorporation applicable to institutional investors. Net of fee performance was calculated by reducing the monthly gross composite return by 1/12 of the highest applicable annual fee of 0.85%. Policies for valuing investments, calculating performance, and preparing GIPS Reports are available upon request. A list of composite descriptions, pooled fund descriptions for limited distribution pooled funds, and broad distribution funds is available upon request. Past performance is not indicative of future results. The investment management fee schedule for separate accounts is 0.85% on the first $50 million, 0.65% on the next $200 million, and 0.55% on assets on all assets above $250 million. Accounts may also pay a performance-based fee that consists of a base fee plus a percentage of the annualized excess return versus the benchmark. Additional information regarding performance fees is available upon request. Actual investment advisory fees incurred by clients may vary which will result in performance that may be higher or lower. The IGEC was created on March 21, 2018 and the inception date for performance is March 31, 2018. MSCI is the source of all MSCI data presented. The MSCI information may only be used for your internal use, may not be reproduced or redisseminated in any form and may not be used as a basis for or a component of any financial instruments or products or indices. None of the MSCI information is intended to constitute investment advice or a recommendation to make (or refrain from making) any kind of investment decision and may not be relied on as such. Historical data and analysis should not be taken as an indication or guarantee of any future performance analysis, forecast or prediction. 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Sands Capital

We are an active, long-term investor in leading innovative growth businesses, globally. Our approach combines analytical rigor and creative thinking to identify high-quality growth businesses that are creating the future. Through an integrated investment platform spanning venture capital, growth equity, and public equity, we provide growth capital solutions to institutions and fund sponsors in more than 30 countries. Sands Capital is an independent, staff-owned firm founded in 1992 with offices in the Washington, D.C. area, New York, San Francisco, London, and Singapore.

All-In Culture

We are one team dedicated to one mission and one philosophy. As a fully independent and staff-owned firm, we attract and retain strong talent, focus on long-term outcomes, and are highly aligned with our clients' interests.

Insight Driven

Businesses that can build a sustainable advantage are few and far between. To seek them, we apply six criteria to separate signal from noise, identify what matters most, and construct differentiated views on tomorrow's businesses, today.

High Conviction for High Impact

All our strategies concentrate investments in only our best ideas and avoid mediocrity. With the intent to own businesses for five years or longer, we seek to create value for clients through the compounding of business growth over time.

Global Perspective with Local Understanding

Innovation-driven growth knows no geographic boundaries. Neither does our research team. We are hands on, on-the-ground, deeply immersed in the ecosystems in which our businesses operate.